

FOOLISH

three-o'clock naps, and by nightfall were soft teacakes with frostings of sweat and wet talcum. People moved slowly then. They ambled across the square, shuffled in and out of the stores around it, took their time about everything. A day was twenty-four hours long but seemed longer. There was no hurry, for there was nowhere to go, nothing to buy and no money to buy it with, nothing to see outside the boundaries of Maycomb County. But it was a time of vague optimism for some of the people: Maycomb County had recently been told that it had nothing to fear itself."

When I was almost six and Jem was nearly four, our summertime boundaries (within a long distance of Calpurnia) were Mrs. Henry Lafayette Adams and her husband, a man judging from his tracks; he dined on raw squirrels and any cats he could catch, that's why his hands were bloodstained—if you ate an animal raw, you could never wash the blood off. There was a long, jagged scar that ran across his face; what teeth he had were yellow and rotten; his eyes popped, and he drooled most of the time."

"Miss Caroline seemed unaware that the ragged, denim-shirted and floursack-skirted first grade, most of whom had chopped cotton and fed hogs from the time they were able to walk, were immune to imaginative literature. Miss Caroline came to the end of the story and said, 'Oh, my, wasn't that nice?' Then she went to the blackboard and printed the alphabet in enormous square capitals."

He said, "My father—"

"Neighbors bring food with death and flowers with sickness and little things in between. That was our neighbor. He gave us two soap cakes, a broken watch and chain, a pair of good shoes, pennies, and our lives."

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"When I was almost six and Jem was nearly ten, our summertime boundaries (within calling distance of Calpurnia) were Mrs. Henry Lafayette Dubose's house two doors to the north of us, and the Radley Place three doors to the south. We were never tempted to break them. The Radley Place was inhabited by an unknown entity the mere description of whom was enough to make us behave for days on end; Mrs. Dubose was plain hell. That summer Dill came to us."

Boo was about six-and-a-half feet tall, judging from his tracks; he dived on his squelchs as many cats he could catch, that was his habit was bloodstained. If you saw a cat paw, you could not wash the blood off there was a long, jagged scar that ran across his face; what teeth he had were yellow and rotten; his eyes popped, and he drooled most of the time."

"Miss Caroline seemed unaware that the ragged, denim-shirted and floursack-skirted first grade, most of whom had chopped try to be as honest as possible, in order to maintain the accuracy of my experiments. But I am not a moralist, and I do not believe in the concept of good and evil."

...in going to make him a big man." She raised
her eyes and no longer came in
early.

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cotton and fed hogs from the time they were able to walk, were immune to imaginative literature. Miss Caroline came to the end of the story and said, 'Oh, my, wasn't that nice?' Then she went to the blackboard and printed the alphabet in enormous square capitals, turned to the class and asked, 'Does anybody know what these are?'"

"Atticus was feeble: he was nearly fifty. When I was asked him why he was so old, he told me he got started late, which we felt reflected upon his abilities and manliness. He was much older than the parents of our school contemporaries, and there was nothing Jem or I could say about him when our classmates said, 'Auntie—'"

"Neighbors bring food with death and flowers with sickness and little things in between. Boo was our neighbor. He gave us two soap dolls, a broken watch and chain, a pair of good-luck pennies, and our lives."

gotten to know the right people, and I've made some important connections. Connections are very important in this business. You'd be surprised how many



with this girl, and
 ions to her
 and never romp
 . So he waited,
 er to the tuning-
 n a star. Then he
 , she blossomed
 e incarnation was
 e, Tom and Daisy —
 s and creatures and
 to their money or their
 whatever it was that kept
 , and let other people clean up
 the mess they had made. . . . I shook hands
 with him; it seemed silly not to, for I felt
 suddenly as though I were talking to a child."

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